CINEMA ▼

Love, Unfiltered

IN HIS LATEST FILM, DIRECTOR AANAND L. RAI PROBES RAW, CONFLICTING IDEAS OF LOVE ACROSS GENERATIONS



With *Tere Ishk Mein*, it's time for another Aanand L. Rai romantic drama which generates much debate and deliberation. Rai is already privy to the fact that words like "toxic" and "deep love" are being thrown for the way his hero (Dhanush) comes across while conversing with his lover, Mukti (Kriti Sanon). But then he'd rather have some chatter than none at all. "You want people to take the story home after watching the film," he says. "When you have that first cup of tea in the morning, it is still with you."

The idea, he notes, stemmed from how he felt that a certain "hunger" was missing from the younger generation when it comes to matters of the heart. "There's a kind of practicality seeping into their romance which wasn't in our generation. We were very black and white, *hum rote huye, hanste huye*, sulk *karte huye dikh jaate thay* (We could be seen crying, smiling and sulking)," he says. "This generation is either managing or hiding it well. I wanted to break that with this one. Both (the lead pair) have different definitions of love and they come from different generations in the way they perceive love, and nobody is wrong."

> IF MUKTI IS ALL ABOUT *"PYAAR MEIN SAMAJHDAARI"*— BEING SENSIBLE IN LOVE—SHANKAR IS ALL ABOUT UNCALCULATED LOVE

The opposing schools of thought lead to what's a necessary ingredient in every story—conflict. In this case it appears to be about settling down. If Mukti is all about "*pyaar mein samajhdaari*"—being sensible in love—Shan-

AANAND L. RAI'S **ROMANCE CANON**



« TANU WEDS MANU (2011)
An uninhibited heroine and generous dose of humour put both Aanand L. Rai and Kangana Ranaut on the map. Its sequel remains one of the highest-grossing female-fronted films.

» RAANJHANAA (2013)
Dhanush's complex character Kundan and A.R. Rahman's lovely soundtrack made this one of the most talked-about romantic dramas.

